TANZANIA

APRIL 2015 – JUNE 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Tanzania leads its African peer set with a perception score of 73, but worsening hospitality and cost sentiment demand urgent attention.

1,326	71%	17%	12%	73/100
RECORDS IN VIEW	POSITIVE	NEUTRAL	NEGATIVE	PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Tanzania enters the reporting period as the strongest performer across its nine-country peer set, holding a **perception score of 73** and a **net sentiment of 58.6** — results anchored by the country's unmatched scenery and wildlife offer. The dominant emotional register is excitement, which points to an audience that is actively aspirational rather than merely aware. The destination is converting attention into intent.

Beneath that strength, two themes are deteriorating in ways that could erode the overall score if left unaddressed. Hospitality negativity has risen by **21.1 points** between the first and second halves of the period — the steepest movement of any theme — while cost sentiment carries the heaviest negative load of any aspect at a **net of -40.7**, well behind the peer average. These are not abstract signals: they represent the friction points that stop a willing traveller from returning or recommending.

The single action this period demands is a targeted hospitality quality programme — briefed to lodge operators, guides and front-line service providers — combined with a value-communication strategy that repositions Tanzania's pricing relative to the experience delivered. Both interventions are needed before the worsening hospitality trend compounds further.

DATA NOTE
The dataset is drawn almost entirely from YouTube comments (99.9% of records), which captures a highly engaged but platform-specific audience. Findings may not fully represent travellers using other review channels.

DATA NOTE
The period label 'April 2015 – June 2026' spans over eleven years at annual granularity; early years (2015–2017) carry thin annual samples and should be read as indicative rather than definitive trend anchors.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

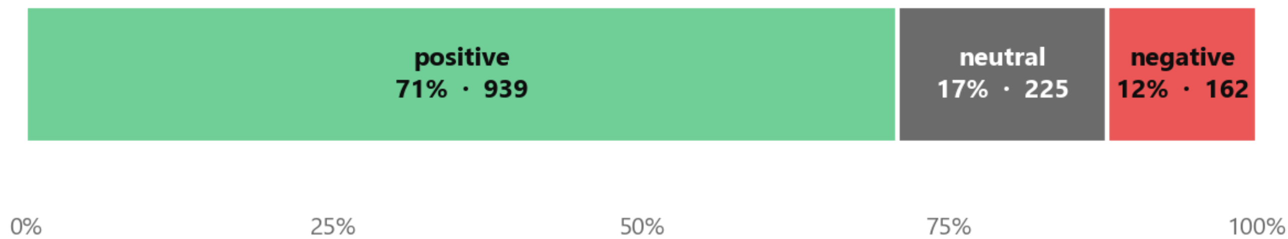
Tanzania's **perception score of 73** on the 0–100 scale places it clearly in positive territory, well above the neutral midpoint of 50. The **net sentiment of 58.6** reinforces that reading: the gap between those who speak favourably and those who do not is substantial. The **positive share of 70.8%** is the highest in the peer group, and the **negative share of 12.2%** is among the lowest, meaning Tanzania is generating both broad positivity and relatively contained criticism — a combination that marks a destination with genuine reputational strength rather than one running on niche enthusiasm.

The **neutral share of 17.0%** is worth examining. A neutral record typically reflects an informational or descriptive comment — someone acknowledging Tanzania without committing emotionally. That segment represents an audience the destination has reached but not yet converted to advocacy. Given that **30.1%** of all records carry an "excited" emotion signal and **10.7%** carry "longing," the emotional energy in the corpus is real and concentrated. Disappointment registers in only **0.8%** of records and fear in another **0.8%** — a reminder that the negative narrative is modest in volume even where it is pointed in content.

The practical implication is that Tanzania's perception base is healthy enough to support an aggressive growth strategy, but the **12.2%** negative share is not negligible — it clusters around specific, actionable themes rather than being diffuse. A destination at this score level can afford to be selective: fix the concentrated problems in hospitality and cost, and the overall score has room to move toward the mid-to-high seventies.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 1,326 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +59 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Scenery is Tanzania's single largest theme by volume, with **428 mentions**, and it is the strongest positive driver: **82.5%** of those mentions are positive against a **net of 72.9**. The landscape — Kilimanjaro, Zanzibar's coast, the Serengeti plains — functions as the country's primary reputational engine. The comment from @african-history-fountain (Apr 2021), urging fellow Africans to invest their holiday spend in Tanzania rather than Dubai or London, captures the aspirational framing that scenery content generates: it is not merely described but used as an argument for rerouting travel decisions. Wildlife follows at **112 mentions** with a **net of 54.5** and **67.0%** positive — strong, though its negative share of **12.5%** suggests that game-viewing expectations are not always met, a point to monitor as its negativity has risen by **5.9 points** across the period.

Hospitality is the most urgent concern in the thematic picture. With **115 mentions** and a **net of 49.6**, it remains a net-positive theme overall, but that aggregate conceals a sharp internal deterioration: negativity rose from **12.9%** in the first half of the period to **34.0%** in the second — a **21.1-point** swing. Food, though reporting a positive net of **46.9** across **32 mentions**, has also worsened, with negativity climbing by **10.2 points** between the two halves. These two themes often travel together in the visitor experience, and their simultaneous deterioration points to a service-quality issue that is deepening rather than correcting itself.

Cost is the sharpest pain point in absolute terms. Its **net of -40.7** across **27 mentions** makes it the only theme in negative territory, and it is deeply so — **59.3%** of mentions are negative. Transport (**39 mentions**, **net 7.7**) and housing (**27 mentions**, **net 3.7**) sit near neutral, indicating neither a strength to promote nor an emergency to manage. Safety, with **24 mentions** and a **net of 12.5**, is modestly positive and holds an advantage over the peer group average, though the volume is too recent and concentrated to treat as a settled narrative — operators should not assume safety concerns have been permanently resolved.

> **DATA NOTE**
> Electricity, weather, and water each fall below the 15-mention minimum and are excluded from headline findings; their data appear in the fact pack for completeness only.

> **DATA NOTE**
> The safety movement trend (negativity rising 12.9 points, second half vs first half) did not clear the 50-record threshold required to report cohort movement; the directional signal is noted but not used as a headline finding.

Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @hichemmaazouzi5764 · Aug 2021 · 2,847 likes · score +0.85
“ ”

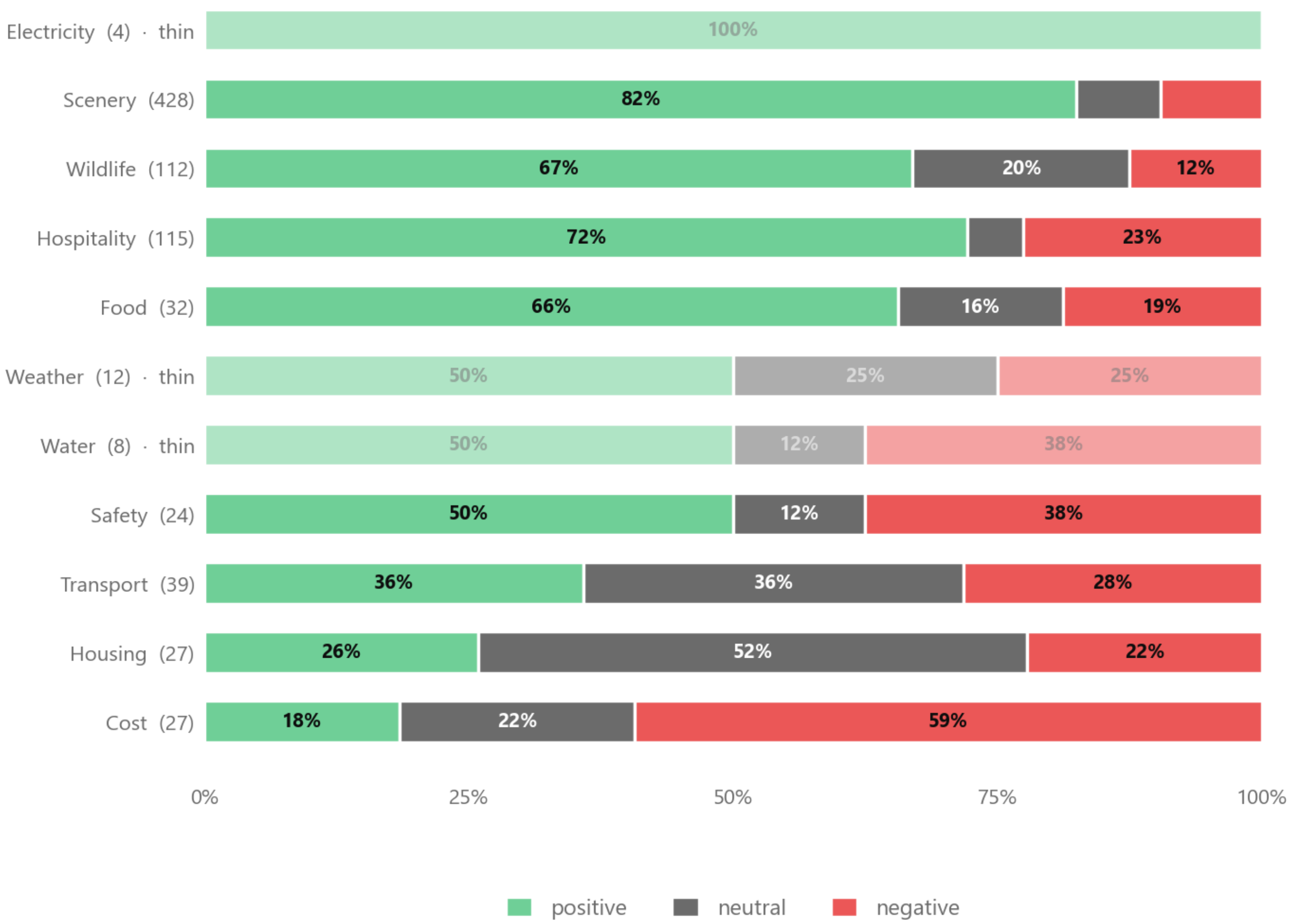
POSITIVE · @jackieaina · Apr 2021 · 1,500 likes · score +0.74
“Def adding Tanzania to my list of future travel destinations!!”

NEGATIVE · @lodybrown3045 · May 2023 · 1,399 likes · score -0.49
“Kama wewe unaikubali Zanzibar tujuane kwa like hata 10 Tu”

NEGATIVE · @World_Statistics2.0 · May 2023 · 203 likes · score -0.45
“Beautiful … i really dont understand what Africans are doing taking holidays in Artificial places like Dubai”

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

The adventure segment is the only visitor cohort that clears the minimum sample threshold of 50 records and can therefore be analysed with confidence. **Adventure travellers account for 146 records**, representing **11.0%** of the overall view. Their **perception score of 74** and **net sentiment of 58.2** track closely with Tanzania's aggregate figures, and their **positive rate of 72.6%** reflects a cohort that is broadly satisfied with what the destination delivers — unsurprisingly, given that Tanzania's scenery and wildlife, the themes that dominate the positive narrative, map directly onto adventure travel motivations. Their **negative rate of 14.4%** is modest and does not indicate a segment in distress. Tanzania is, in effect, already well-positioned for the audience it most reliably attracts.

The budget, luxury, and business cohorts each fall below the 50-record threshold and cannot be compared against one another or against the adventure segment in this view. Their indicative figures suggest meaningful variation in perception across segments, but acting on those figures without adequate sample support would be premature. What the segment picture does confirm is that the adventure traveller is the dominant voice in this dataset — and that any campaign or product investment calibrated primarily to that cohort is working with the most robust evidence available. The tourism board should consider whether current data collection methods are capturing luxury, business, and budget travellers adequately, since those cohorts may represent significant revenue potential that is currently invisible to measurement.

DATA NOTE
Only one visitor cohort — adventure — clears the 50-record minimum required for reportable analysis. Budget (17 records), luxury (11 records), and business (4 records) are below threshold; their figures are indicative only and cannot be ranked or compared.

DATA NOTE
Only 13.4% of records were classifiable into a segment, leaving 1,148 records unclassified. Segment-level findings should be read as reflecting a vocal minority of the full dataset rather than the complete visitor population.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Adventure	146	11.0%	74/100	+58
Budget · thin	17	1.3%	47/100	-18
Luxury · thin	11	0.8%	67/100	+36
Business · thin	4	0.3%	33/100	-50

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Tanzania holds **first place** among its ten-country peer group with a **perception score of 73**, ahead of Ghana, Rwanda, and Senegal (each at 70), Kenya (69), Zimbabwe (68), South Africa (65), Egypt (64), Nigeria (62), and Morocco (39). Its **positive rate of 70.8%** is the highest in the set and its **negative rate of 12.2%** is the lowest among reportable peers, meaning Tanzania is not merely leading on a composite score — it is ahead on both the positive driver and the negative drag simultaneously. That is a structurally strong position, not a statistical artefact.

On individual themes, Tanzania's advantages are most pronounced in hospitality and wildlife. Its hospitality net of **49.6** sits **27.8 points** ahead of the peer average of 21.8 — the largest positive gap of any theme. Its wildlife net of **54.5** leads the peer average by **20.1 points**. These two themes, alongside scenery, form the reputational architecture that separates Tanzania from the rest of the field. Safety also shows a reportable gap: Tanzania's net of **12.5** compares to a peer average of **-4.4**, a **16.9-point** advantage — meaning Tanzania is, at present, perceived as safer than the average of its competitive set, a differentiator that tourism marketing rarely exploits as explicitly as the data would justify.

The one reportable gap running against Tanzania is cost. Its cost net of **-40.7** falls **28.1 points** below the peer average of -12.6 — the largest negative gap in the benchmark. Every other destination in the group is perceived as better value for money, and the gap is wide enough to represent a genuine competitive vulnerability rather than a marginal difference. Housing also trails the peer average by **13.9 points** (Tanzania net 3.7 versus peer average 17.6), suggesting accommodation quality or variety is underperforming relative to what travellers find elsewhere on the continent. Both gaps are consequential because they affect repeat visitation and recommendation rates — the metrics most likely to drive long-run volume growth.

DATA NOTE
Cameroon (16 records) did not clear the reportable threshold and is excluded from comparative analysis.

DATA NOTE
The transport and food aspect gaps did not clear the 10-point gap margin required to be stated as reportable competitive differences; they are noted in thematic analysis but not used as benchmark findings.

DATA NOTE

The scenery gap is also below the 10-point margin and is excluded from the benchmark narrative.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52
Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The long-run perception trajectory is one of genuine improvement. Tanzania's perception score opened at **51** in 2015 — barely above neutral — and reached a sustained range of 75–84 through 2016–2021, a period of strong and consistent positive momentum. The **peak year by record volume was 2025**, with **263 records**, confirming that audience engagement has grown substantially over the period. Across the full span, the direction is improving, with an overall **change of +17.0 points** from first to last period — a result that reflects a destination that has genuinely built its international profile.

The more pressing signals, however, are in the recent trajectory. Perception has declined from its 2021 high of 80 to **68** in 2026, and the negative share has risen from **5.4%** in 2021 to **18.5%** in 2026 — the highest negative rate in the entire period. This is not a single-year anomaly: 2024 (16.4% negative) and 2025 (14.1% negative) both showed elevated negativity before 2026's reading. The pattern is directional and sustained. At the theme level, hospitality's negativity rose by **21.1 points** and food's by **10.2 points** — both classified as worsening — while wildlife negativity moved up by **5.9 points**, also classified as worsening. These three themes together suggest a service-layer problem accumulating across the visitor journey.

Transport is the one theme showing a reportable improvement, with negativity falling by **5.2 points** between the two halves of the period. This is a meaningful shift given that connectivity and in-country movement are persistent friction points across African destinations; progress here is worth communicating. Scenery, the volume leader, is classified as stable with only a **3.0-point** movement — reassuring given how much reputational weight it carries, but a reminder that natural assets cannot be assumed to deliver indefinitely without complementary service improvements around them.

DATA NOTE
Annual samples for 2015 (2 records) and 2016 (11 records) fall well below the 50-record minimum. Perception scores for those years should be treated as directionally indicative only and not used as precise benchmark anchors.

DATA NOTE
The cost trend movement (improving, -10.4 points) did not clear the reportable threshold for trend analysis; it is noted in thematic context but not used as a trend headline.

DATA NOTE
Weather improved by 50.0 points between halves but carried only 6 mentions in each half, placing it below the 15-mention threshold; it is excluded from trend headlines.

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)
Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

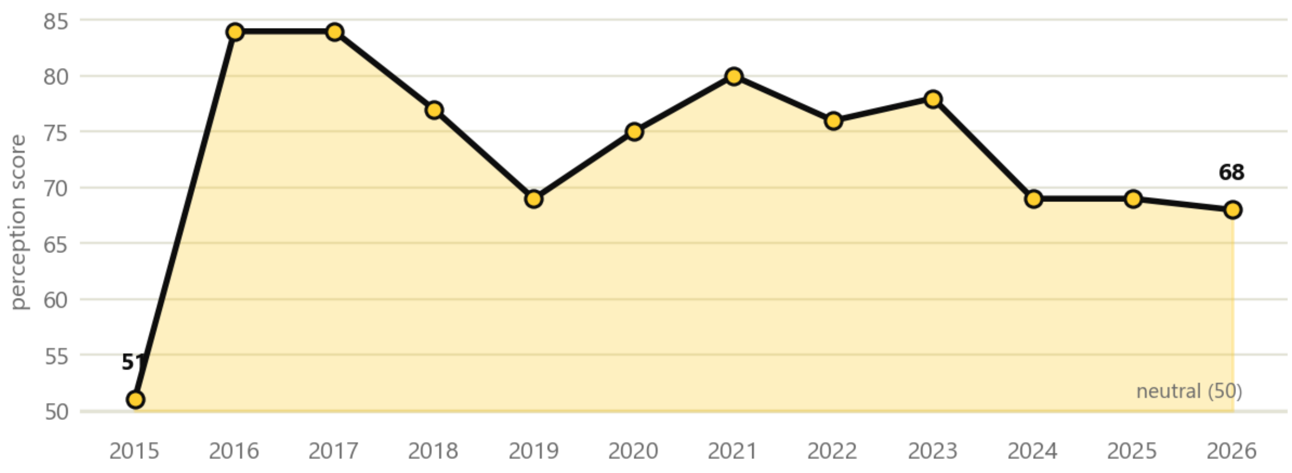
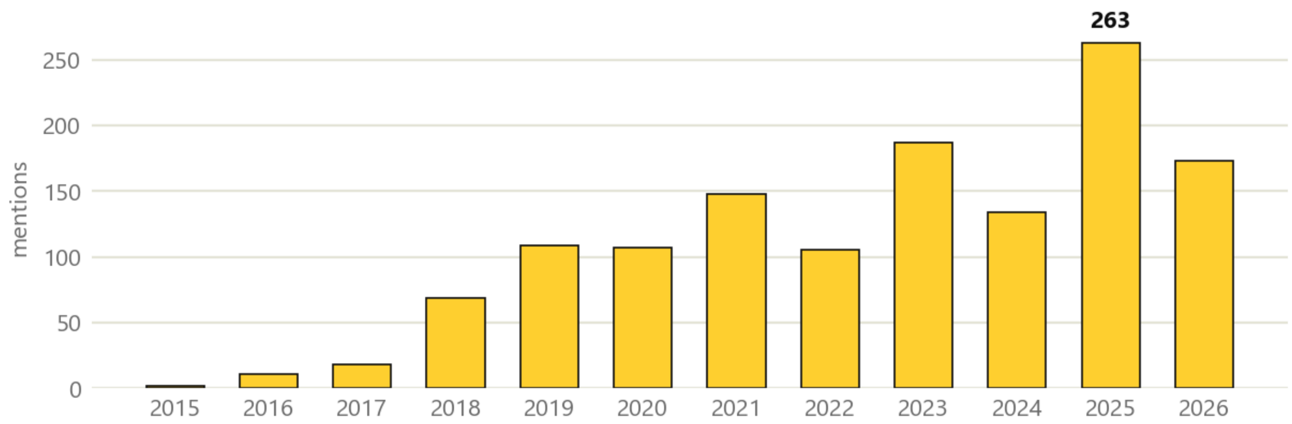


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)
Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The worsening hospitality trend — negativity up **21.1 points** across the period — is the most urgent finding in this report. The Tanzania Tourism Board should commission a structured quality-assurance audit of front-line hospitality providers in the highest-traffic zones, with particular focus on the Serengeti, Zanzibar, and Kilimanjaro circuits where visitor volume is greatest. The audit findings should feed directly into operator certification standards and guide the allocation of any capacity-building support. Messaging to the trade — tour operators, lodge groups, DMCs — should make explicit that hospitality is now Tanzania's fastest-deteriorating perception theme and that service consistency, not scenery, will determine whether the destination holds its number-one peer ranking in the next review cycle.

The **-40.7** cost net and the **28.1-point gap** behind the peer average demand a value-communication strategy, not a pricing reduction. Tanzania's hospitality and wildlife scores are, on the evidence, worth a premium — the problem is that visitors are not being given the language to understand why. The tourism board's consumer-facing content and trade briefing materials should explicitly map the cost of a Tanzania visit against the specific value elements that no peer destination can match: the wildlife net of 54.5, the safety advantage of 16.9 points over the peer average, and the scenery volume that drives more mentions than any other theme. This framing is especially relevant for the adventure segment — the only reportable cohort — whose strong perception scores indicate they respond well to experiential value arguments.

Wildlife negativity has risen by **5.9 points** and is classified as worsening. The tourism board should work with national park authorities and licensed operators to understand whether unmet expectations are driven by overcrowding at peak sites, guide quality variation, or a mismatch between marketed and actual game-sighting conditions. Corrective action might include seasonal visitor distribution incentives, mandatory guide accreditation refreshes, or pre-visit expectation-setting content that narrates the variability of wildlife encounters honestly. Allowing this trend to continue unchecked risks eroding the theme that is Tanzania's second-largest competitive advantage over its peer group.

Tanzania's **16.9-point safety advantage** over the peer group average is a reportable competitive differentiator that current marketing largely ignores. The tourism board should test safety as an explicit campaign message — not in a defensive framing, but as a positive destination attribute — particularly in source markets where safety perceptions of the African continent suppress conversion. Similarly, transport's improving trend (**-5.2 points** in negativity) represents a story of progress worth telling to trade partners who have historically flagged in-country connectivity as a deterrent. Both advantages are most credibly communicated through first-person visitor voices, and the strong engagement signals in the existing YouTube corpus — including comments with thousands of interactions — suggest that video-format social content remains the highest-leverage channel for Tanzania's perception management.

> **DATA NOTE**
> Luxury, budget, and business segment recommendations cannot be made with statistical confidence in this view, as none of those cohorts cleared the 50-record minimum. Separate targeted research for those segments is advisable before committing segment-specific spend.

> **DATA NOTE**
> The cost improvement signal (-10.4 points, second half vs first half) did not reach the reportable threshold; the cost recommendation is therefore based on the overall net sentiment figure and the benchmark gap rather than on an improving trend.

08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Tanzania
Year range	2015–2026
Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	April 2015 – June 2026
Records	1,326
Generated	19 Aug 2026 12:37 UTC
Narrative	Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data.

Evidence base: 1,325 YouTube comments, 1 YouTube transcript segment. 91% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.